ChartBench

The complete user guide

Nashville Number charts, lyrics slides, and set lists —
one file, no install, your songs stay on your device.

thechartbench.com

Guide edition: August 23, 2026

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A word from the author

Friends — a short note on why this software exists.

I've been a musician all my life and have led worship services for more than twenty years. One frustration never went away: building chord charts the way I wanted them. Everyone has a preference, and I'm no different. There are great resources out there, but many were designed and built long before the remarkable tools we have at hand today. Yes — LLMs. There will be no secrets: this was vibe-coded, with love.

That said, I've tried to build as much flexibility into the tool as possible, and I'll keep doing so as ideas come in. The intention is that this is free for everyone, always and forever. So it's an open-source project, licensed under Creative Commons (details in chapter 20). Download it and do as you must.

Happy playing.

— *Matt*

1 Welcome to ChartBench

ChartBench is a chart editor built for musicians — worship teams very much included. You write a song once, and ChartBench gives it to you every way you and your band need it: a Nashville Number chart for the players, the same chart instantly in any letter key (with or without a capo), lyrics slides for the projection team — exported straight into ProPresenter, PowerPoint, or OpenLyrics — printable set lists for a whole service or set, and standard file formats other software can read.

Three ideas shape everything in the app:

- **Charts are stored as Nashville Numbers.** Underneath every song, chords are scale-degree numbers (1–7) that never change no matter what key you view it in. Numbers are the canonical format; letter keys are a *view* of the song, not a rewrite of it. Change the Display Key as often as you like — the song itself never mutates.
- **One file, no install.** The entire application is a single HTML file. It runs in any modern browser, works offline, and needs no account, server, or installation. You can run it from a website or keep your own copy on a laptop. **One thing worth knowing up front:** a Chromium-based browser — **Chrome, Edge, Brave** — is the recommended home, because the Library Folder (chapter 18) that keeps your songs as real files on your computer works only in those. Everything else works everywhere. ChartBench is a laptop/desktop tool by design — a larger tablet in landscape works; on a phone the app says so and leaves it at that.
- **Your songs stay with you.** Everything you write is saved on your device — in the browser's own storage, and, if you choose a **Library Folder** (chapter 18), as plain files in a folder you own. Nothing is uploaded anywhere.

This guide is always one click away: the **Guide** button at the right end of the top bar, next to ⚙, opens it in a new tab.

2 Getting started

First launch

The first time ChartBench opens, two things happen: **three demo songs** — "Romans 11", "Small Offering", and "The Mighty, Righteous, Risen" — are placed in your library for quick review and for exploring the environment, and a one-time welcome message explains the Nashville Number storage idea. Read it once and dismiss it — you can replay it later from Settings.

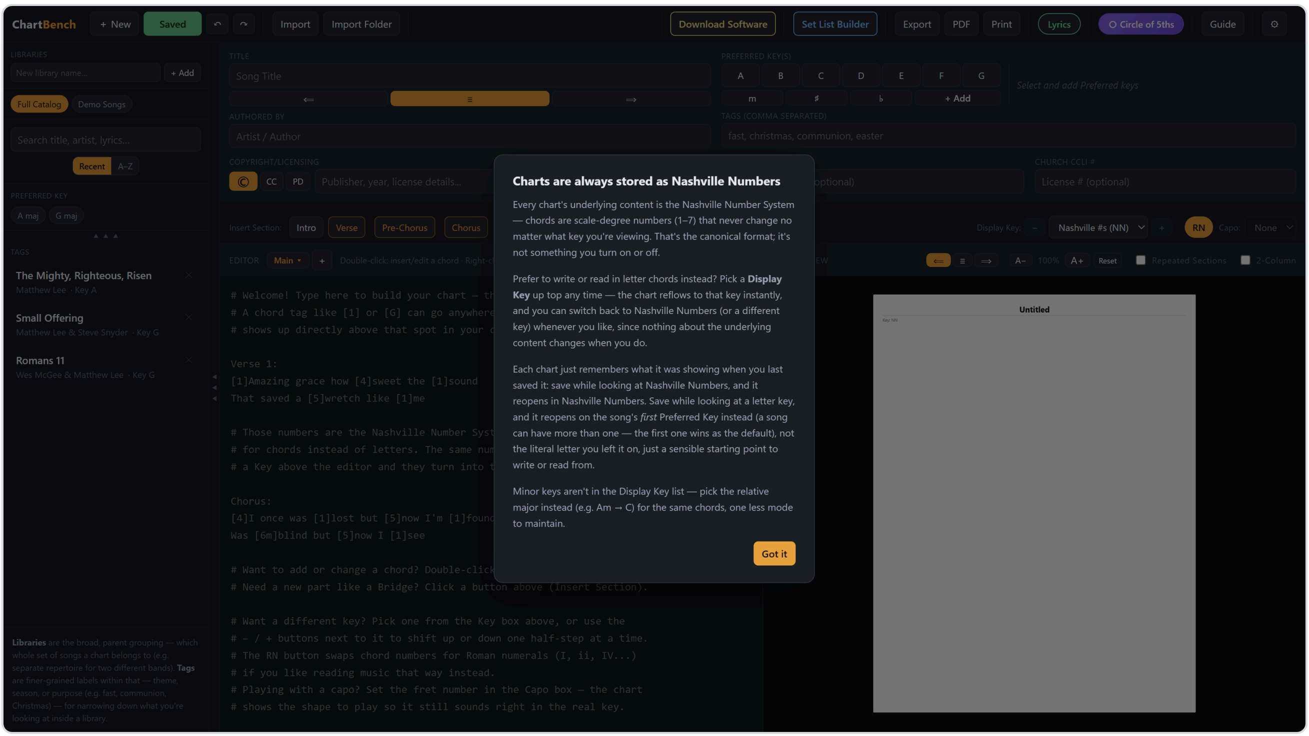


Fig. 1 — First launch: the one-time explanation of how charts are stored.

Getting your own copy

If you're using ChartBench on the web, the pastel-yellow **Download Software** button in the top bar saves a complete local copy — one file, `ChartBench.html` — to your device. Double-click that file and the full app opens in your browser. A local copy works offline; the only features that need an internet connection are **PDF** and **PowerPoint** export, which load their converter libraries from the web.

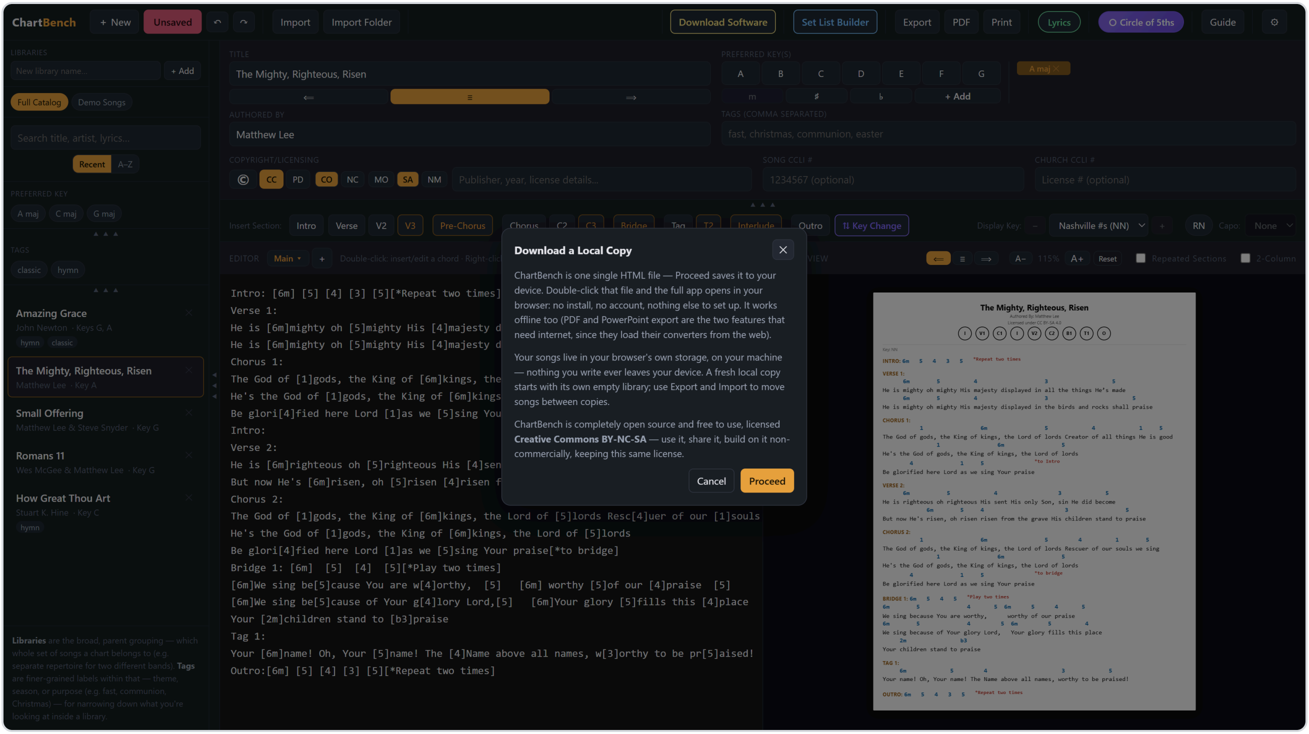


Fig. 2 — Download Software: what a local copy means, and the license it comes under.

Important — where your songs live. ChartBench has two places it can keep songs, and it helps to understand both from the start:

- **The browser's own database** — always on, automatic, nothing to set up. Every Save goes here. It's tied to the exact copy of the app you're using, so the website, a downloaded file, and a second browser each keep their *own* separate library, and clearing the browser's site data erases it.
- **A Library Folder** (optional; Chrome, Edge, or Brave) — a real folder on your computer that mirrors the database: one file per song, written on every Save and reconciled on every launch. It's the durable copy — it survives cleared browser data, and if the folder lives in OneDrive, Dropbox, Google Drive or iCloud Drive, the same library follows you to another computer. Set it once in Settings; chapter 18 has the details.

Without a Library Folder, move songs between copies with Export and Import (chapters 11–12) and back up with **Export entire library** in Settings.

3 The interface at a glance

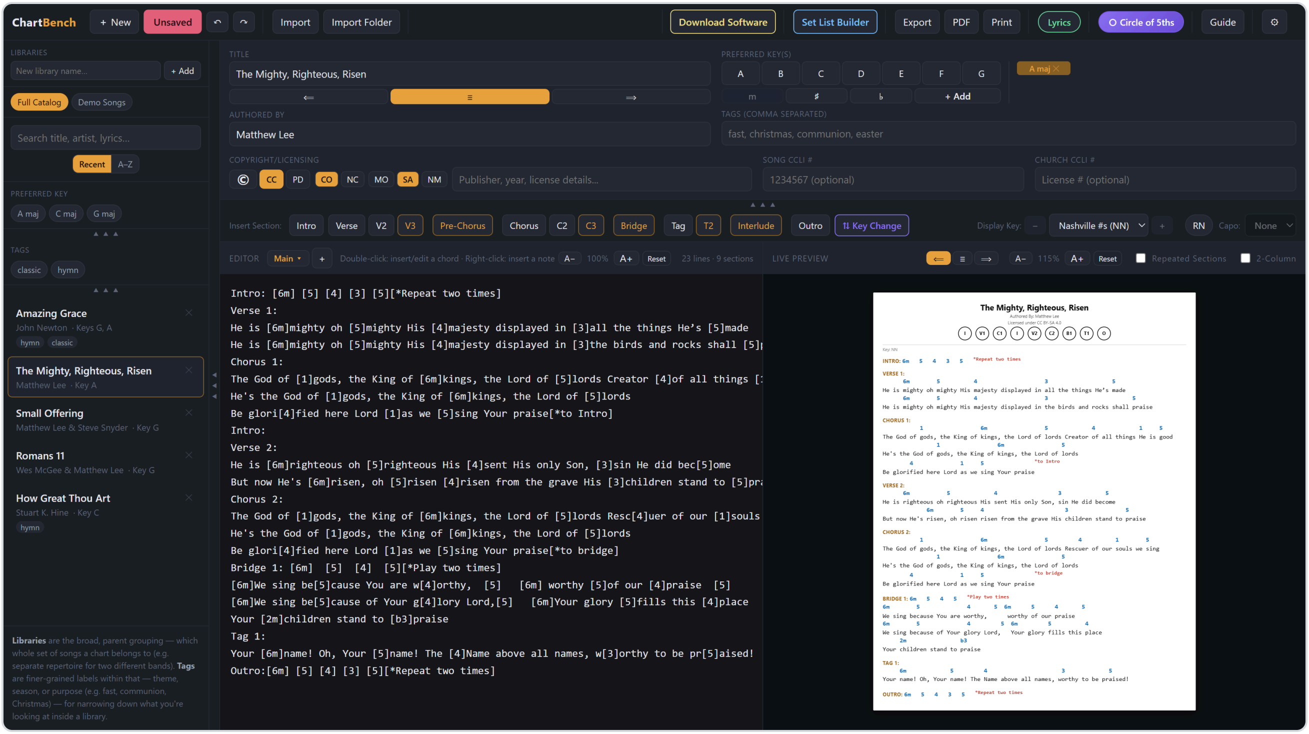


Fig. 3 — The full workspace with a song open.

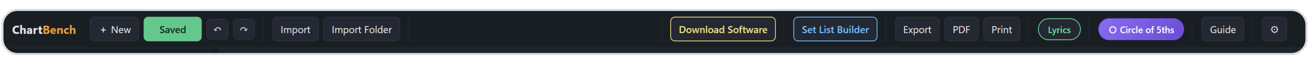
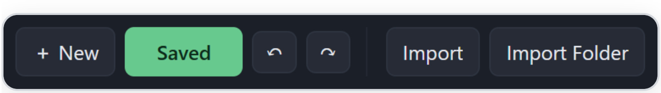


Fig. 4 — The top bar, left to right: file actions, import, Download Software, Set List Builder, output, Lyrics, Circle of 5ths, Guide, Settings.

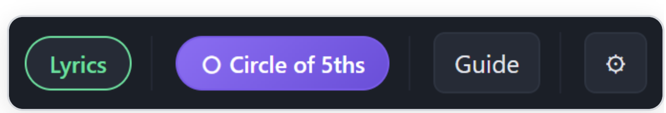
File actions



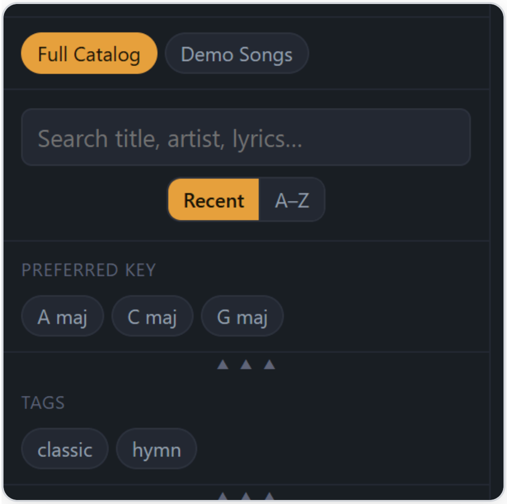
+ New starts a blank song. **Saved / Unsaved** is both the Save button and the save indicator (below). ↶ ↷ are Undo and Redo. **Import** takes one or many chart files; **Import Folder** takes a whole directory and files every song in it under a library named after the folder (chapter 11).

Modes, tools, help

Lyrics (mint) switches to slide-building mode (chapter 14). ○ **Circle of 5ths** (purple) opens the chord wheel in its own window. **Guide** opens this document. ⚙ opens Settings.

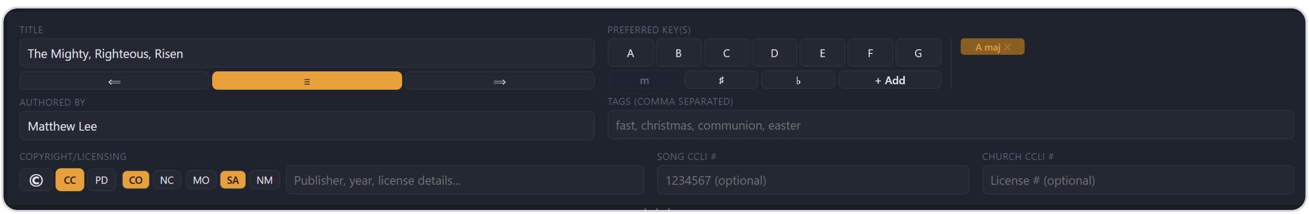


Below the top bar, from left to right:

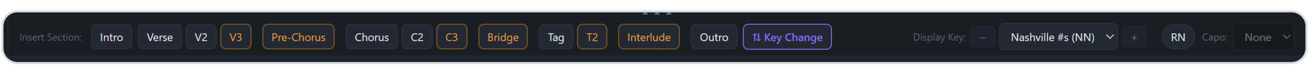


Sidebar (left)

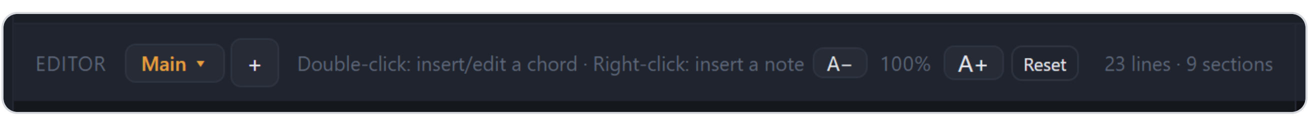
Your song library: libraries, search and sort, filters for preferred key and tags, and the song list itself (chapter 10).



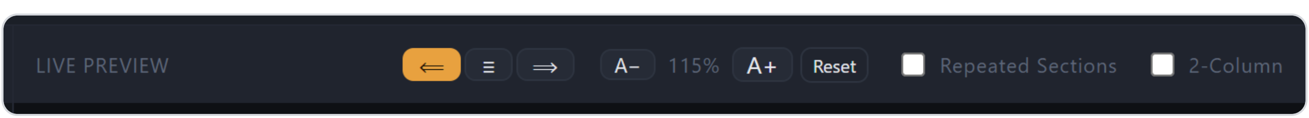
Meta bar — everything *about* the current song: title (with alignment buttons), author, Preferred Key picker and chips, tags, copyright/licensing, and CCLI numbers. It collapses with the small ▲▲▲ handle to give the editor more room; the Title always stays visible.



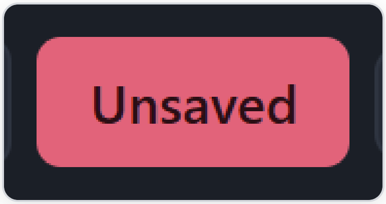
Structure bar — one-click section insertion (Intro, Verse, Chorus...), the Key Change button, and the display controls: Display Key with transpose − / +, the RN (Roman numeral) toggle, and Capo.



Editor (center) — the plain-text chart source. Chords live inline in square brackets: `[1]Amazing grace`. Its header carries the hint line (what double-click and right-click do right now), the editor's own text-size stepper, and a line/section count.

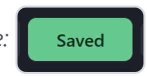


Live Preview (right) — a true print preview: real page-sized sheets, paginated exactly the way Print and PDF will break them, with chart justification buttons, the chart text-size stepper, and the Repeated Sections and 2-Column toggles in its header. The page always scales to fit the pane whole, whatever the window size.



The Save button is the save indicator

It reads **Saved** in green when everything is stored, and flips to **Unsaved** in red the moment anything changes — a keystroke, a chord, a key-change, a checkbox. One click (or `Ctrl`+`S`) stores the song and it calms back down.

The same button in its calm state: 

4 Your first chart

1. **Click + New** (or press `Ctrl`+`N`). A blank song opens; the editor shows a short worked example as placeholder text that disappears the moment you type.
2. **Give it a title and author** in the meta bar. The arrow buttons under the title choose whether the printed chart's header is left, center, or right aligned.
3. **Insert your first section.** Click **Verse** in the structure bar. A `Verse 1:` header lands in the editor with the cursor placed right after it — a chord picked now becomes a lead-in chord on the header line itself.
4. **Type the lyrics** under the header, one sung line per line.
5. **Add chords** by double-clicking any word (chapter 5).
6. **Save.** The red "Unsaved" button (or `Ctrl`+`S`) stores it in the library. Every Save also snapshots a version you can restore later (chapter 17).

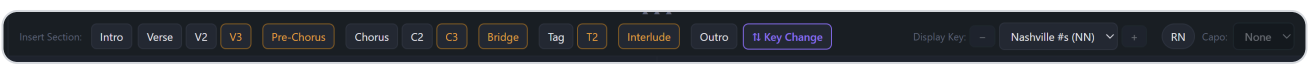


Fig. 5 — The structure bar: section buttons on the left (the highlighted one shows the next number), Key Change, then Display Key, RN and Capo on the right.

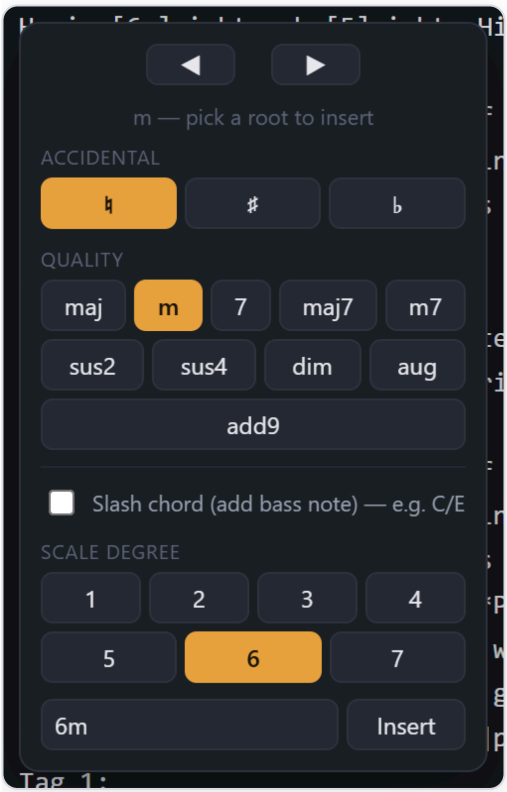
The section buttons are smart: once a `Verse 1` exists, the bar offers **V2**; use a section again (a repeated chorus, say) and the same button just inserts another header. The highlighted "next number" button always shows where the numbering will go next.

Undo & Redo

Undo (`Ctrl`+`Z`) and Redo (`Ctrl`+`Shift`+`Z`) step through a history of what you actually did: a burst of typing is one step (a pause of about half a second ends the step), and **every mouse-driven edit is its own step** — each chord picked, note inserted, section button clicked or key-change marker placed. Undo never reaches past the moment the song was opened. Display changes (picking a Display Key, transposing, the RN toggle, restoring a version) aren't undo steps — they're reversible from their own controls — and Lyrics mode keeps a completely separate history (chapter 14).

5 Working with chords

Chords are typed inline in square brackets — `[1]`, `[4]`, `[6m7]`, `[5/7]` — directly before the syllable they land on. You can type them by hand, but the chord picker is faster and can't make a typo.



The chord picker

Double-click anywhere in the chart text — on a word, at a syllable, in a space, wherever the chord belongs — and the picker opens right there. Top to bottom: an accidental (♮ ♯ ♭), a quality (maj, m, 7, maj7, m7, sus2, sus4, dim, aug, add9), the **Slash chord** tick, then the root — clicking a root inserts immediately. In Nashville view the roots are scale degrees 1–7; when a letter key is displayed they become A–G (below), always matching what the editor shows.

Double-click an existing chord instead and the picker opens pre-loaded with its values — here an existing `6m`: quality m, degree 6 — plus ◀ ▶ arrows that nudge the chord one character at a time along the lyric, the fastest way to land it on exactly the right syllable.

Slash chords: in Nashville view you pick the chord first, then the bass degree *relative to that chord* (1 = its own root). In letter view the bass is simply a note name.

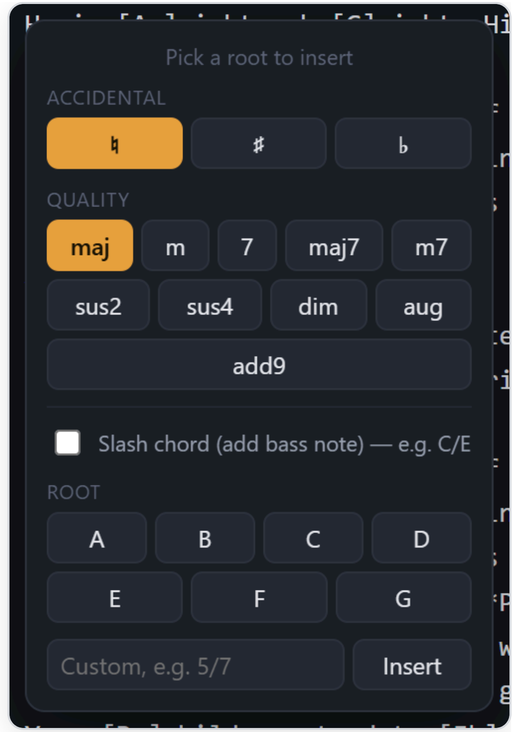
Anything unusual goes in the Custom box and is inserted verbatim — `[1sus4/5]`, `[N.C.]`, whatever the song needs.

Fig. 6 — Editing an existing chord in Nashville view. Each insert or edit is its own Undo step.

The same picker in a letter key

With the Display Key set to **C**, the picker offers roots **A–G** instead of degrees and inserts letter chords — `[C]`, `[Am7]`, `[G/B]` — exactly as the editor is showing them. Underneath, the song is still stored as numbers; pick a letter here and ChartBench records the matching degree for the key you're in.

Fig. 7 — Inserting a chord while viewing the song in C.



> **Roman numerals:** the **RN** button (structure bar) displays and enters Nashville content as Roman numerals — `I, ii, IV` — instead of arabic numbers. It's purely a notation style; the stored song is identical either way. RN grays out while a letter key is displayed, since it only applies to number view.

6 Notes & annotations

Performance notes

Right-click any line to attach a note to it — "Repeat 2x", "build", "drums out". Type it, press `Enter`. The note is stored as a `[*…]` token at the end of that line and renders on the chart as a bold, superscript instruction marked with an asterisk, visually distinct from chords. Notes never appear on lyrics slides or in lyrics exports.

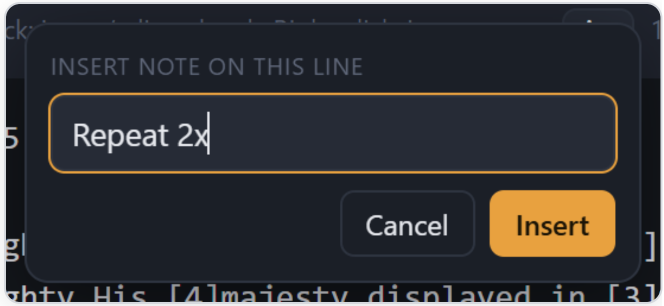


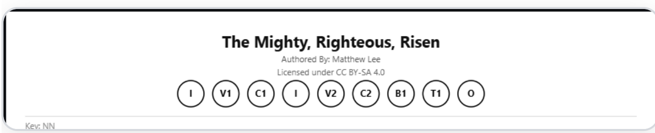
Fig. 8 — The note popup.

Full-line comments are also available: start a line with `#` and it renders as an italic gray remark on the chart — useful for reminders that aren't tied to one lyric line. (The blank example chart uses these heavily.) Like notes, they're stripped from lyrics.

7 Structure, the song map & arrangements

Sections

A section is any line ending in a colon: `Verse 1:`, `Chorus:`, `Bridge 2:`. The structure-bar buttons insert them for you and track numbering automatically. A header line may also carry chords with no lyrics after it — `Intro: [6m7] [37] [2m7] [37]` — which renders as an instrumental section with the progression inline.



The song map

Every labeled section becomes a round badge under the chart's header — **I, V1, C1, I, V2, C2, B1, T1, O** — in performance order. This row *is* the song map: the band sees the whole arrangement at a glance before the first downbeat. It's for the chart only; it never appears on slides or in lyrics exports.

Fig. 9 — Title, author, license line, and the song map.

Repeats without clutter

To repeat a section exactly — a chorus sung again later — insert its bare header with nothing under it. ChartBench understands: by default the chart body *doesn't* reprint the lyrics (saving page space), but the song map shows the badge in position, and lyrics slides (chapter 14) reuse the original section's content. One written-out chorus, referenced as many times as the arrangement needs.

Prefer every section on the page in performance order? Tick **Repeated Sections** in the Live Preview header and each reprise prints in full. It's saved with the song, so print, PDF, and set lists follow whichever way you set it.

Key changes mid-song

The purple **Key Change** button inserts a modulation marker at the cursor — set the number of semitones with − / + and Insert. Everything after the marker transposes accordingly in letter-key views; in Nashville view the chart shows "Modulate: Up 2 semitones," since numbers themselves are key-independent.

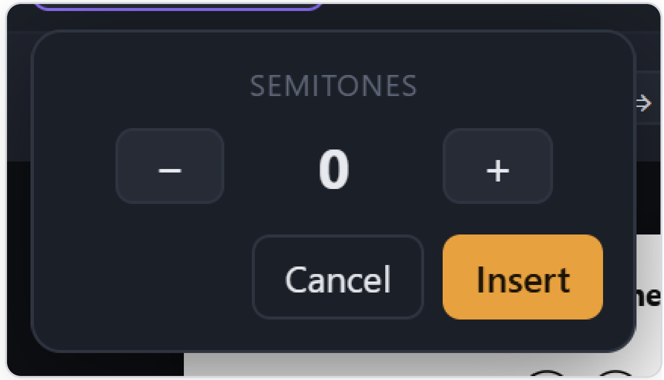


Fig. 10 — The Key Change popup.

Arrangements: one song, several forms

The acoustic version, the full-band chart, the shortened Christmas Eve cut — same song, different playable form. ChartBench calls these **arrangements**. An arrangement owns the chart and everything that hangs off it: the sections and chords, the Lyrics-view slide shaping, text size, justification, Repeated Sections, the key it was last shown in, its capo, and its own version history. The *song* owns the identity every arrangement shares — title, author, CCLI, licensing, tags, preferred keys, libraries — so a fix to the title reaches all of them. Every song starts with one arrangement called **Main**; until you add a second, nothing about this shows.

The control in the editor heading

Main ▾ beside the word Editor names the arrangement in the editor. Click it for the menu: the song's arrangements (✓ on the one showing — pick another to switch), then **New arrangement**, **Rename…**, and **Delete this arrangement**. The **+** beside it is the shortcut for New: it asks for a name and starts the new arrangement as a *copy of what's showing*, which is nearly always what you want — "like this, but…".

Unsaved edits travel with their arrangement when you switch, so you can flip between them mid-edit. Switching alone doesn't mark the song unsaved; the arrangement showing when you **Save** is the one the song reopens on. A song always keeps at least one.

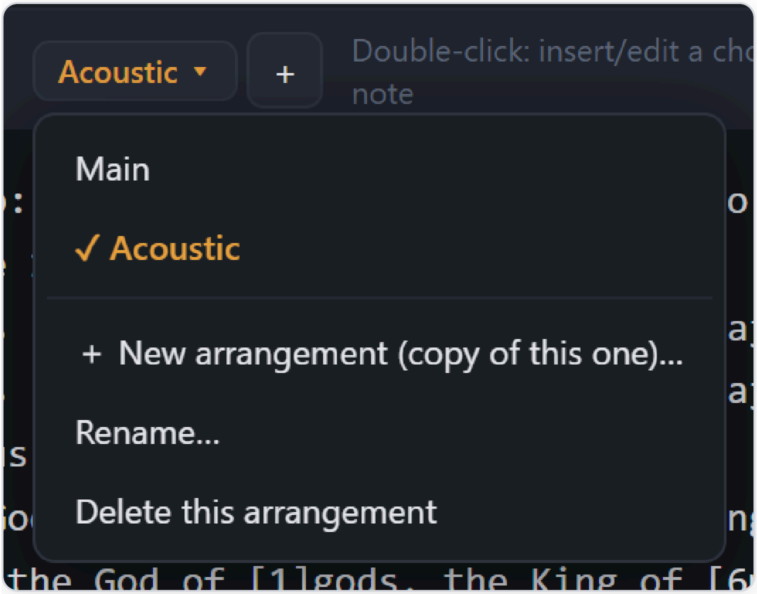


Fig. 11 — Two arrangements; "Acoustic" is in the editor.

On the chart

Once a song has more than one arrangement, the chart prints the name on the Key/Capo line, right-justified — so a printed "Acoustic" chart is never mistaken for the main one. Exports pick it up too: files are named `Song Title - Acoustic`.

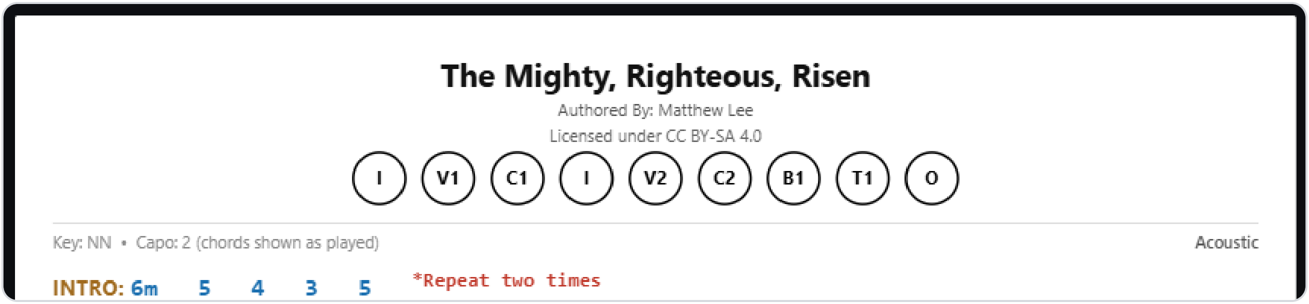


Fig. 12 — "Acoustic", opposite Key and Capo.

In the library and set lists

The song list shows a song's arrangements as blue chips (the active one brighter). In the **Set List Builder** an entry for such a song gets an arrangement picker next to its Key and Capo, so a set can call for "The Mighty, Righteous, Risen — Acoustic" and print, PDF and lyrics exports use exactly that; saved sets remember the choice (chapter 15).

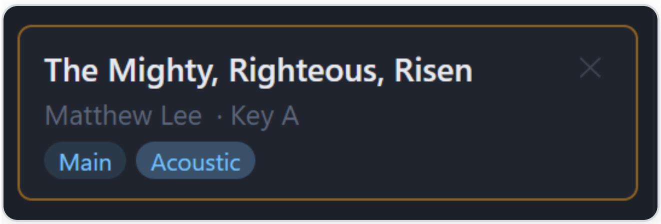


Fig. 13 — Chips under the title.

8 Keys, transposition & capo

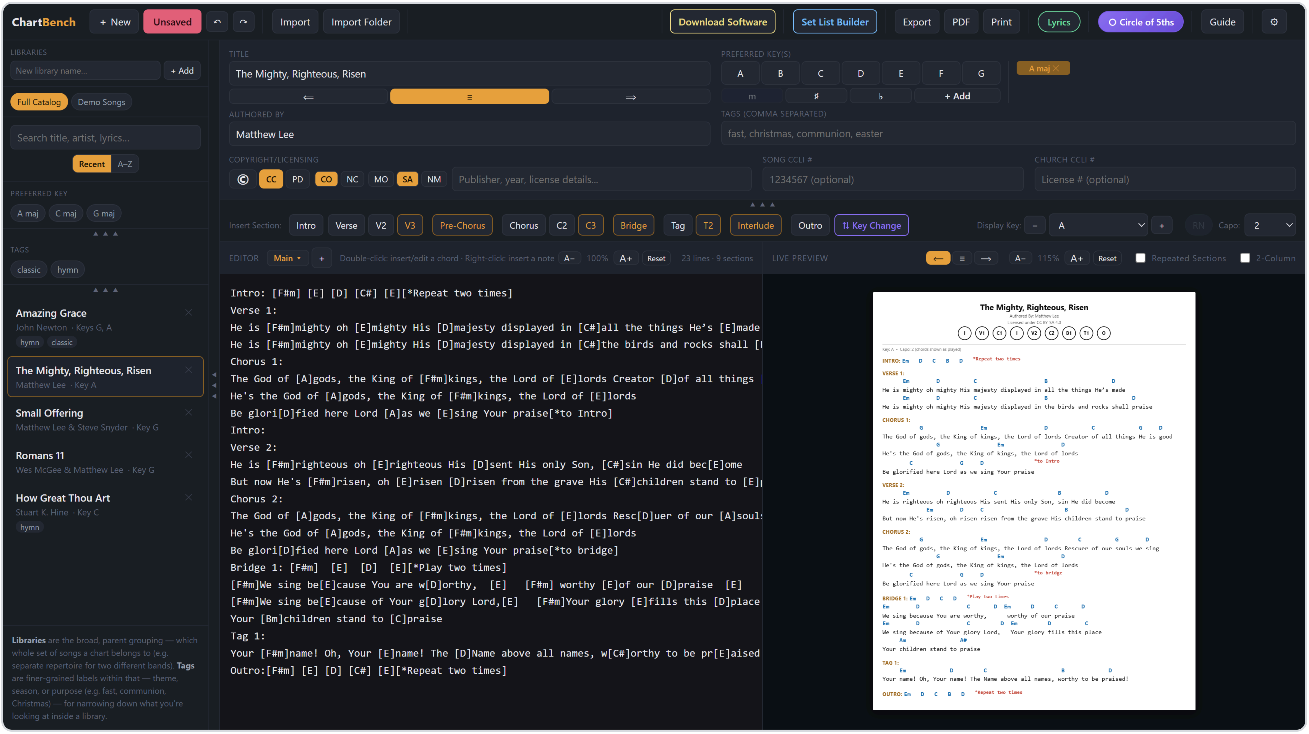
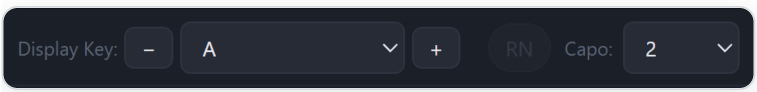


Fig. 14 — The same song viewed in A with Capo 2: the editor reflows into letter chords and the chart shows the shapes to play. Note the red "Unsaved" Save button.

Display Key, – / +, RN, Capo



The **Display Key** dropdown is a lens, not an edit. Pick **A** and the whole editor and preview reflow into letter chords in A; pick **Nashville #s (NN)** and they flow back to numbers. The underlying song never changes.

– / + step the display a half-step at a time through the common key spellings — C, D♭, D, E♭, E, F, F♯, G, A♭, A, B♭, B — with every chord respelled for the new key.

Capo: set a fret and the chart displays the *shapes to play* — chords transposed down by the capo — while still sounding in the displayed key; the header notes "chords shown as played." Capo applies to letter views only.

Fig. 15 — The display controls, shown in A with Capo 2.

Preferred Keys

Preferred Keys are pure metadata: the keys you like to sing the song in. Build one with the letter picker in the meta bar (A–G plus m / ♯ / ♭ toggles, with impossible spellings disabled) and click **+ Add**; it becomes a chip, and a song can carry several. They show in the library list and feed the sidebar's Preferred Key filter.

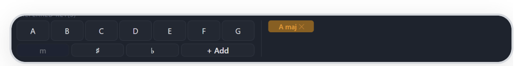


Fig. 16 — The picker with an "A maj" chip already added.

> **What reopening looks like:** a song reopens in exactly the Display Key it was showing when you last saved it — G, B♭, or Nashville numbers — and an exported song carries that key with it, so a library imported from your export lands in your keys. Either way the stored chart is the same numbers underneath.

9 Metadata, copyright & CCLI

The basics

Title and **Authored By** print at the top of the chart with your chosen alignment. **Tags** (comma separated) are free-form labels — *fast, communion, Christmas* — that power the sidebar's tag filter.

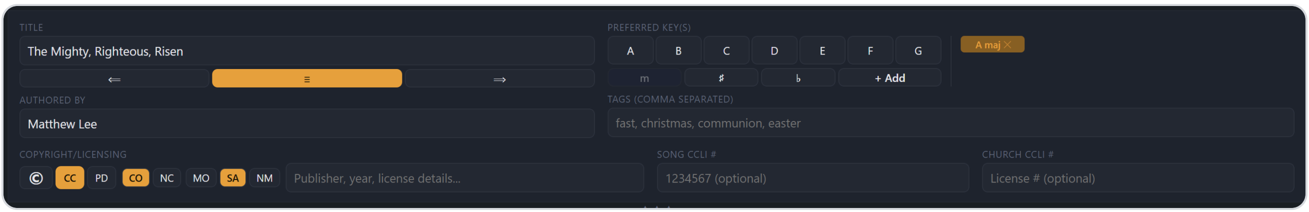
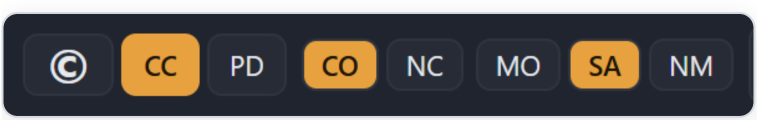


Fig. 17 — The meta bar: title and alignment, author, Preferred Keys, tags, copyright/licensing, CCLI numbers.

Copyright & licensing

Three modes sit left of the copyright text field:

- **©** — standard copyright. Type the holder/year details in the field; the chart prints them with a © symbol.
- **CC** — Creative Commons, with a built-in license picker (below).
- **PD** — public domain. The field disables and the chart simply prints "Public Domain".



The Creative Commons picker

Selecting **CC** reveals two questions, one at a time. **May others monetize** covers and remixes? **CO** (commercial OK) or **NC** (non-commercial). **May they modify** the song? **MO** (freely), **SA** (ShareAlike — their version must carry this same license), or **NM** (no modifications). Hover any button, including CC itself, for a plain-English explanation.

Fig. 18 — Here, on "The Mighty, Righteous, Risen": CO + SA.

What the chart prints

The two answers resolve to one of the six standard licenses and the chart's credit line prints it exactly as Creative Commons writes it: **CC BY 4.0**, **CC BY-SA 4.0**, **CC BY-ND 4.0**, **CC BY-NC 4.0**, **CC BY-NC-SA 4.0**, or **CC BY-NC-ND 4.0** — "*Licensed under CC BY-SA 4.0*" in the example. Anything typed in the text field follows after a colon. Until both questions are answered the line stays a generic "Licensed under Creative Commons."

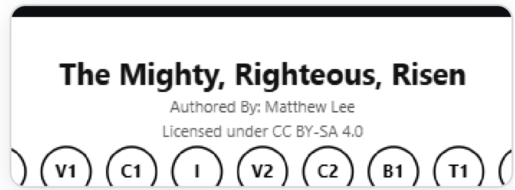
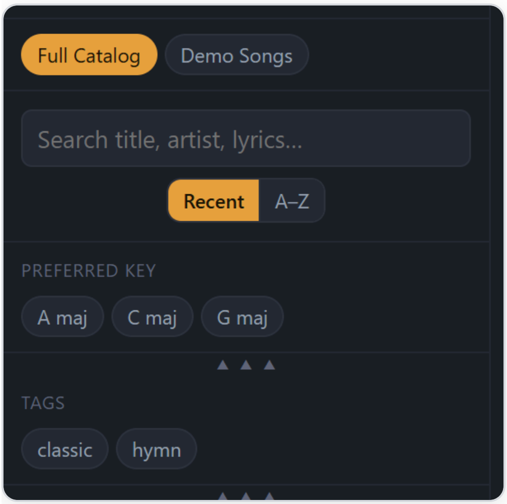


Fig. 19 — The resolved license on the chart header.

CCLI numbers

Song CCLI # is the song's own CCLI catalog number (optional) — it prints beside the author. **Church CCLI #** is your congregation's license number; when present the chart prints "*Used by Permission CCLI #: …*", and the last lyrics slide carries the same compliance footnote. Enter your church's number once in **Settings → Church CCLI License Number** and every new song pre-fills it automatically.

10 The library



Finding songs

Library chips (top) appear once more than one library exists; *Full Catalog* shows everything. **Search** checks title, author, lyrics, preferred keys and tags at once. **Recent / A–Z** orders the list by last edit or alphabetically — the Set List Builder's library pane has the same toggle and the two stay in sync. **Preferred Key** and **Tags** chips narrow the list; several chips widen the match (any-of). Each filter row collapses with its ▲▲▲ handle.

Fig. 20 — Libraries, search and sort, key and tag filters.

The song list

Each row shows title, author, preferred keys and tags; the open song is highlighted. **Click** to open, **right-click** to assign or unassign libraries, ✕ to remove a song from the app (and, if a Library Folder is connected, its file).

The right-click popup lists every library as a chip — click to add the song, click again to take it out — with a box to create a new one. *Full Catalog* is never offered as a chip, because it isn't a library you add songs to: it's where every song lives by default. When a song is in at least one library the popup ends with **Remove from all libraries**, which clears them and leaves the song in Full Catalog only.

Libraries are the broad, parent grouping — whole repertoires, e.g. two different bands. Every song starts in *Full Catalog*, which always shows every song and is the only grouping the app makes on its own — in particular, a connected Library Folder (chapter 18) is *not* a library; it's where the files live. Create a library from the box at the top of the sidebar with a song open, from the right-click popup, or with Import Folder. The demo songs arrive in a "Demo Songs" library; delete them whenever you like — **Settings** → **Data** → **Restore demo songs** brings any of them back.

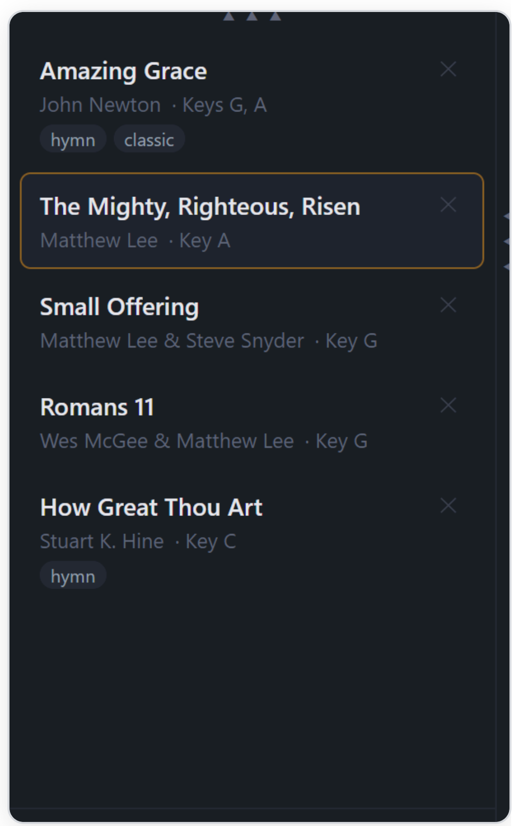


Fig. 21 — Three songs, one open.

11 Importing songs

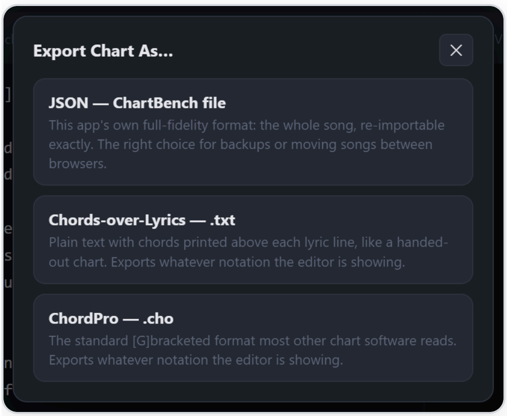
Import accepts one or many files at once; **Import Folder** takes a whole directory and additionally creates a library named after the folder — one folder in, one repertoire out. Every imported song is saved to the library immediately. Four formats are understood:

> **Import Folder and libraries:** the name of the folder you pick becomes the library name for *every* song in the import, subfolders included — it overrides any library a ChartBench file already names. So name the folder what you want the library called. It can't be run on your connected Library Folder (chapter 18): that folder already *is* the library — use **Sync now** in Settings to pick up files added there by hand.

Format	Extensions	How ChartBench handles it
ChartBench JSON	.json	The app's own export — full fidelity: chart, lyrics slide breaks, preferred keys, the key it was last shown in, its text-size zoom, and its version history all round-trip. A whole-library export (one file holding every song) imports every song in it. Each file carries the song's identity, so importing one that's already in the library **updates that song** rather than adding a second copy.
ChordPro	.cho .chordpro .pro	Reads `{title}`, `{artist}`, `{key}`, `{capo}`, `{ccli}`, `{copyright}`; the `[C]word` body is native.
OpenSong XML	.xml	Reads title/author/key/CCLI/copyright; converts OpenSong's dot-prefixed chord lines and [V1]-style markers.
Chords over lyrics	.txt	Plain text with chord lines above lyric lines (letters or Nashville numbers) — merged automatically onto the right syllables. Title/author from the first two lines; `Key:` and `Capo:` lines respected.

> **Keys at import:** a file that states its key (say, G) is converted to canonical Nashville Numbers automatically — a stated key is a fact, so no guessing is involved — G becomes the song's first Preferred Key, and the song opens showing G, just as the file was written. A file with no stated key is left as-is in letter form; convert it later with one click when you know its key.

12 Exporting charts



Export Chart As...

JSON — ChartBench file. The whole song, exactly as stored: chart (always in canonical Nashville numbers), lyrics slide breaks, preferred keys, the key it's showing, its zoom, version history. The format for moving songs between copies of the app; re-imports to precisely the song it came from.

Chords-over-Lyrics (.txt). A classic handout: chords printed above each lyric line, plus `Key:`, `Capo:`, and an `Order:` line carrying the song map (`Order: I V1 C1 I V2 C2 B1 T1 O`).

ChordPro (.cho). The bracket format most other chart software reads, with the standard metadata directives.

Fig. 22 — The chart export picker.

> **.txt and ChordPro are what-you-see:** they write whatever notation the editor is currently showing. Displaying Nashville numbers? The file has numbers. Want to hand a guitarist a G chart? Set Display Key to G first, then export. (JSON is the exception — it's always canonical.)

13 Print, PDF & text size

Print (`Ctrl`+`P`) and **PDF** produce the chart exactly as the Live Preview shows it — same pages, same breaks, because the preview *is* the print layout. Pages are **US Letter** by default; switch to **A4** in Settings and the preview, print, PDF and set-list output all change together. Pagination is phrase-aware: sections and their lines are kept together sensibly rather than sliced mid-phrase. PDF downloads the pages as a single file named after the song (this feature needs an internet connection, for its converter library).

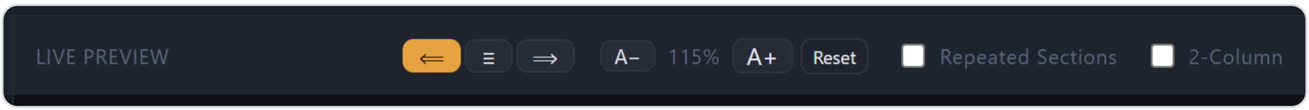


Fig. 23 — The Live Preview header: chart justification (⟸ ≡ ⟹), chart text size (A– / 100% / A+ / Reset), Repeated Sections, 2-Column.

- **Justification** — ⟸ ≡ ⟹ align the chart body (sections, chords and lyrics move together) left, center or right. Saved with the song; the header has its own alignment under the Title.
- **Chart text size** — the A– / A+ stepper scales the whole chart in 5% steps. The zoom is remembered *per song* and travels in its JSON export, so the big-print chart for the pianist stays big wherever it goes.
- **2-Column** flows the chart in two columns, handy for compact one-pagers. **Repeated Sections** is explained in chapter 7.

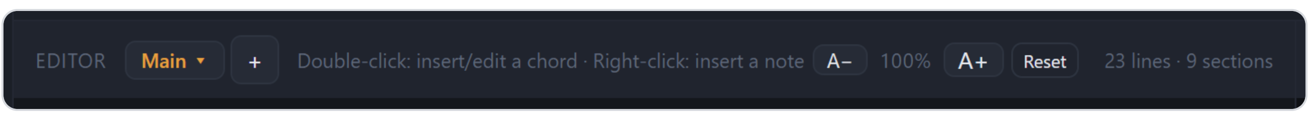


Fig. 24 — The editor header has its own A– / A+ stepper. This one sizes the editor text only — a workspace preference that's remembered on this device, never saved into a song, and never affects what prints.

14 Lyrics mode & presentation slides

The mint-green **Lyrics** button flips ChartBench into a different job: turning the song you already wrote into projection-ready slides. The editor pares down to lyrics only — chords, section markup, comments and notes stripped — and the preview becomes a slide deck.

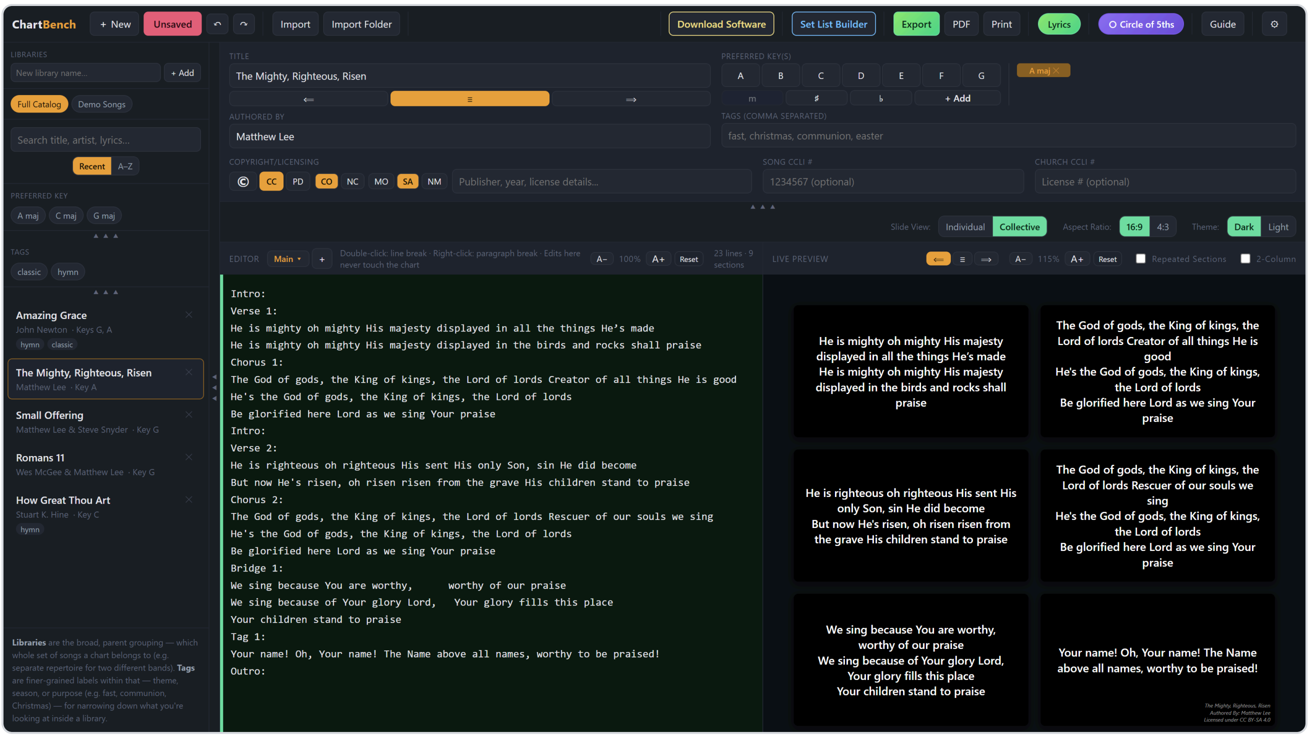


Fig. 25 — Lyrics mode, Collective view: every slide at once. One section per slide; every paragraph break starts a new slide.

Shaping the slides

The lyrics view is its **own copy** of the words, kept in sync with the chart one way: edit lyrics in the chart and the lyrics view refreshes; edit the lyrics view and the chart is untouched. That makes it the place for screen-specific polish — a comma or an "oh," that reads fine on a chart but looks wrong projected can simply be fixed here, and the musicians' chart stays exactly as they read it. In this mode:

- **Type** freely — reword, fix punctuation, delete. The editor hint reminds you that edits here never touch the chart.
- **Double-click** — insert a *line break* at the click point.
- **Right-click** — insert a *paragraph break*, which means a **new slide**.
- **Capitals are automatic:** the first letter of every line and paragraph is capitalized for you — when lyrics arrive from the chart, as you type, and when you insert a break. (Leading quotes

are skipped over, so `"i once was lost` becomes `"I once was lost`.)

Undo/Redo work here on a separate history from the chart's; Left/Right arrows move the caret while you're typing and flip slides when you're not. Repeated bare sections (chapter 7) reuse their original lyrics — a repeated chorus gets its slides without retyping.

> **One trade-off to know:** if you later change the chart's *lyrics*, the lyrics view is rebuilt from the chart and screen-side edits and breaks made here are lost. Chord edits don't trigger this — only changes to the words themselves. Finish the chart's words first, then polish the slides.

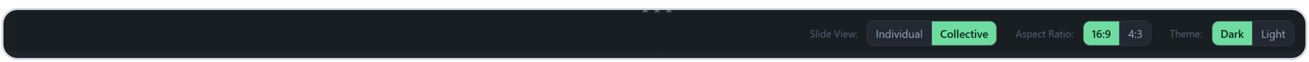


Fig. 26 — In Lyrics mode the structure bar becomes slide controls: Slide View (Individual / Collective), Aspect Ratio (16:9 / 4:3), Theme (Dark / Light), and ‹ › navigation with a slide counter.

Individual view & the compliance footnote

Individual view shows one slide at a time with ‹ › navigation (or the arrow keys). The **last slide** carries a small footnote — title, author, license line, church CCLI number — like the compliance block churches show at the end of a song. Dark (white on black) and Light themes, and 16:9 or 4:3, shape every slide and every export the same way.

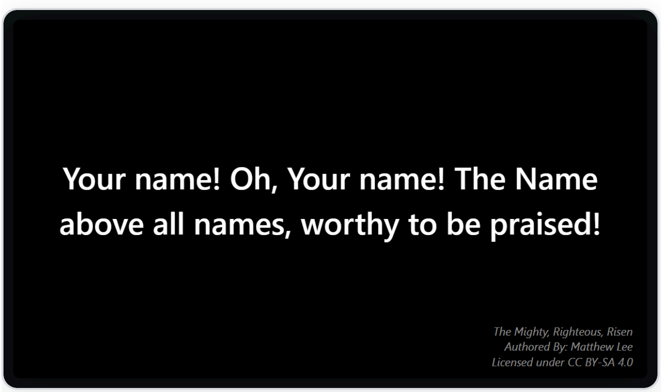


Fig. 27 — The final slide, dark theme.

Exporting lyrics

Export Lyrics As...

In Lyrics mode the **Export** button flips green — its job has changed. All three formats are built from this parsed Lyrics view, never the raw chart, so the song leader's slide-break work arrives done for whoever runs the presentation.

OpenLyrics XML — the open worship-song standard that OpenLP and others import directly. Sections become verses, paragraph breaks become grouped line blocks, the song's structure becomes the verse order, and the performance key rides along.

ProPresenter .txt and **PowerPoint .pptx** are described below.

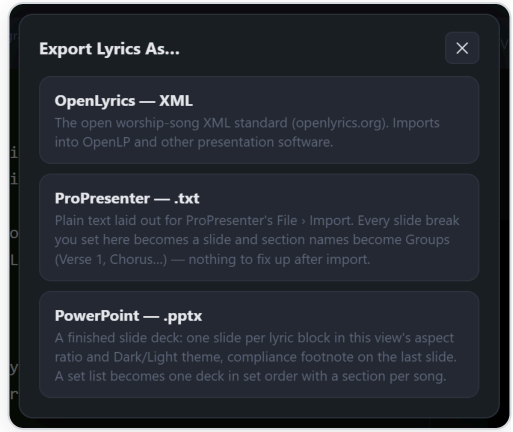


Fig. 28 — The three lyrics formats.

ProPresenter

Plain text written to the exact grammar ProPresenter's own text importer reads, so the import needs zero clean-up. The file *is* the Lyrics view's slides: every paragraph break you set is a slide, each section name becomes a ProPresenter **Group** (`Verse 1`, `Chorus`, `Pre-Chorus 2`, `Bridge`, `Tag`, `Intro`, `Interlude`, `Outro`), and a repeated section is written out again in song order so the deck plays top to bottom with no Arrangement to assemble. Only lyrics go in — leader notes, chords, and the song map never appear, and copyright/CCLI stay in ProPresenter's own document fields. A custom section name has no ProPresenter group, so its slides simply continue the previous group rather than risk a stray label on screen.

1. In ProPresenter choose **File › Import › File...** and pick the `.txt` (select several at once for a whole set).
2. In the import dialog leave the parsing at **Slides delimited by: Blank Line**, one delimiter per slide.
3. Pick your **Template**, slide **Size**, and destination **Library**, then Import. The presentation arrives titled, grouped, and paginated exactly as the Lyrics view showed it.

PowerPoint

A finished `.pptx` deck: one slide per Lyrics-view slide, in the aspect ratio and Dark/Light theme the ribbon is set to, text centered and sized to fit each slide, the compliance footnote on the song's last slide, and each section's name tucked into the slide's speaker notes (invisible on screen, handy for the operator). Needs an internet connection the first time, to fetch its builder library.

15 The Set List Builder

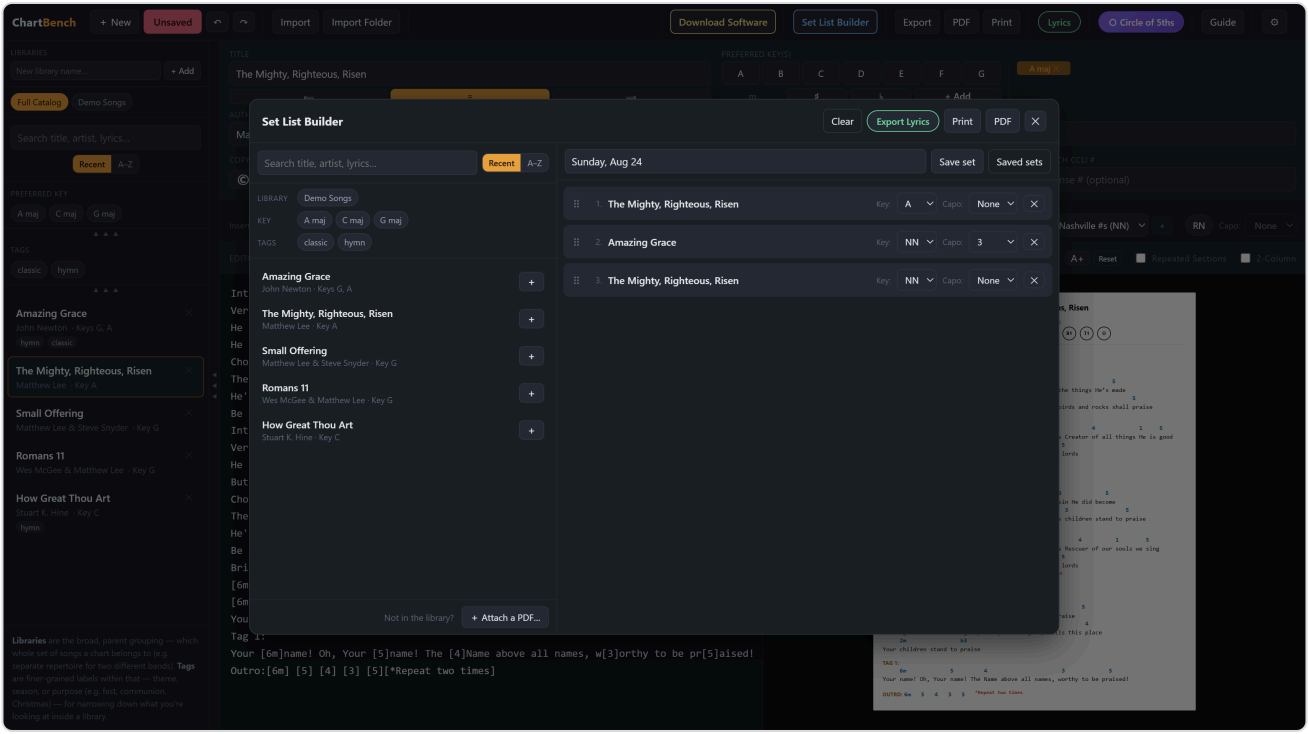


Fig. 29 — A set in progress, named "Sunday, Aug 24": three entries, one song twice, each with its own key and capo.

The sky-blue **Set List Builder** assembles a whole set. The library pane on the left has the sidebar's search, Recent / A–Z sort, and Library / Key / Tags filters; the set builds on the right.

Building the set

Drag songs from the library pane into the set, or click a song's **+**. Every entry defaults to Nashville Numbers and carries its own **Key** and **Capo** — what's selected is what gets generated. A song with more than one arrangement (chapter 7) also gets an **arrangement picker** on its entry. The same song can appear twice (an opener reprised in a new key at the close); each copy is independent. Drag the ⠿ handle to reorder, ✕ to remove.

Not in the library? *Attach a PDF…* (or drop a PDF from the desktop onto the set) inserts an existing PDF chart as an entry; its pages print and export in sequence with the rest.

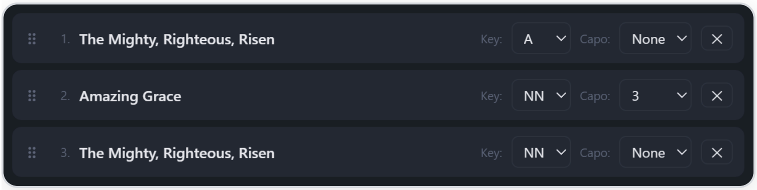


Fig. 30 — Three entries: The Mighty, Righteous, Risen in A, Amazing Grace in NN with capo 3, and the opener again in NN.

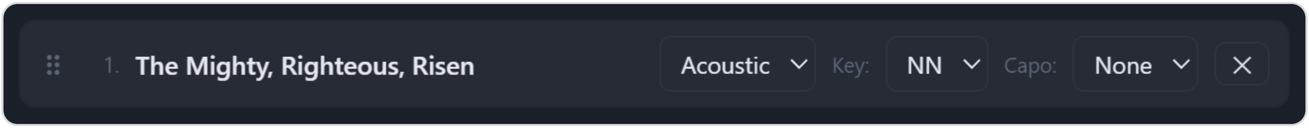


Fig. 31 — An entry for a song with two arrangements: the picker sits left of Key and Capo.

Saving sets, bringing them back

Type a name in the bar above the set and click **Save set** (or press `Enter`) — order, keys, capos and attachments are kept. Leave the name blank and it's named with today's date. Saving under an existing name **updates** that set, so "Sunday, Aug 24" evolves as you tweak it instead of piling up copies.

Saved sets (N) opens the panel: every saved set, newest first, with item count and date. **Load** brings one back into the builder (asking first if it would replace a non-empty set); ✕ deletes it after a confirm — the songs themselves are untouched. **Clear** empties the working set and never touches saved ones.

The working set — and its name — survive closing the popup and reloading the app. Saved sets are mirrored to the Library Folder (chapter 18) too, so they follow the library.

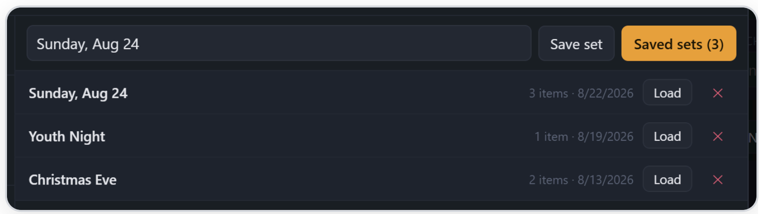
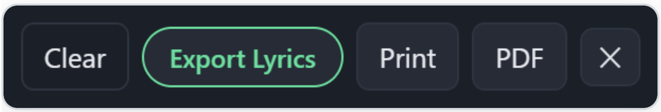


Fig. 32 — The set-name bar with the saved-sets panel open.

Output



Print and **PDF** produce every chart in set order, each song on a fresh page in its chosen key/capo at its own saved text size; attached PDFs drop in as-is. **Export Lyrics** offers the same three formats as the Lyrics view: OpenLyrics writes one file per entry numbered in set order (`01_…` , `02_…`); ProPresenter writes one `.txt` per song, named by title (a song appearing twice exports once — its lyrics are the same in any key); PowerPoint builds **one deck for the whole service**, in set order, with a PowerPoint section per entry. Files are named after the set.

Fig. 33 — Clear, Export Lyrics, Print, PDF.

16 The Circle of Fifths

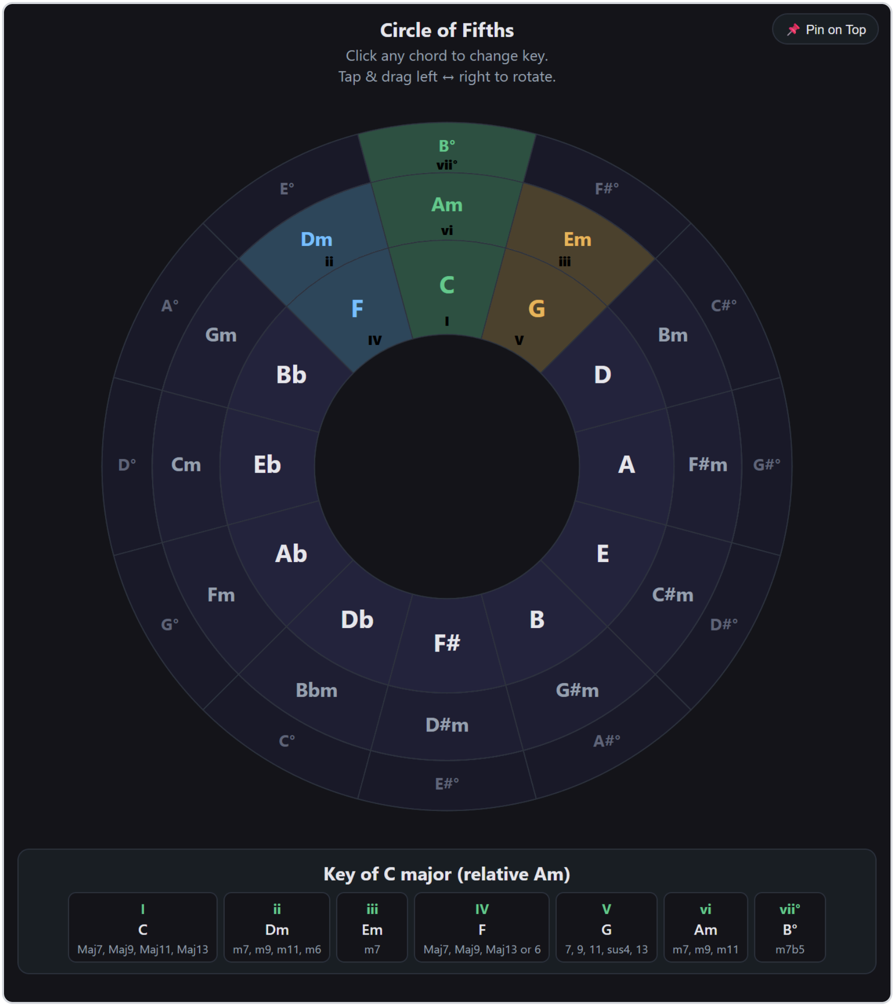
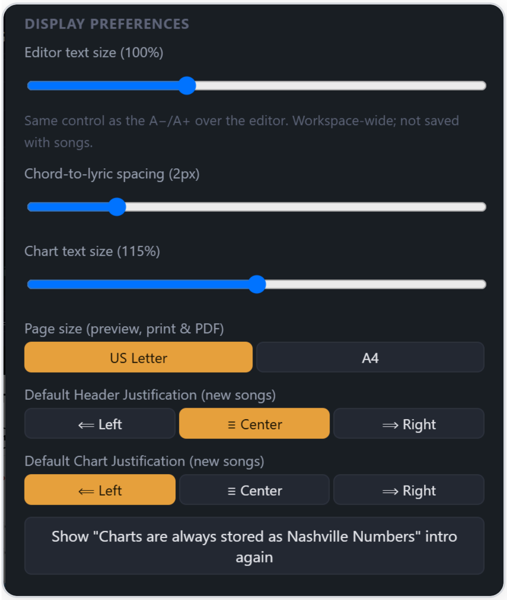


Fig. 34 — The Circle of Fifths window: green tonic at the top, blue subdominant (IV) and gold dominant (V) beside it, and beneath the wheel the key panel — every diatonic chord of the current key with its Roman numeral and the extensions that suit it.

The purple ○ **Circle of 5ths** button opens the wheel in its own window (with a *Pin on Top* option so it floats over your work). It opens set to the song's current Display Key — or C for a Nashville view. Click any chord to re-center on that key, or drag left/right to spin. The highlighted trio is always the working heart of the key: **I** (green, center-top), **IV** (blue), and **V** (gold), with each ring showing the majors, relative minors, and diminished chords that belong to the key.

17 Settings



Display preferences

Editor text size — the same control as the A−/A+ over the editor; a workspace setting, never saved with songs. **Chord-to-lyric spacing** — how far chords sit above their words. **Chart text size** — the same control as the preview's A−/A+; per song. **Page size** — US Letter or A4 for preview, print, PDF and set lists. **Default header justification** and **default chart justification** for new songs. And a button to replay the welcome explanation.

Fig. 35 — Display Preferences.

Church CCLI & Data

Church CCLI License Number — set once; every new song pre-fills its Church CCLI # field. **Data** shows a storage status line (whether the browser granted persistent storage, your last full backup, and whether a Library Folder is mirroring), then **Version history** for the current song (a snapshot on every Save; restore any of the last 25), **Export entire library** as one JSON file, **Restore demo songs** (brings back any demo you deleted, without duplicating ones still there), and **Clear local database** — the nuclear option; with a Library Folder connected, the next sync simply brings everything back from the folder. Version history is per arrangement (chapter 7).

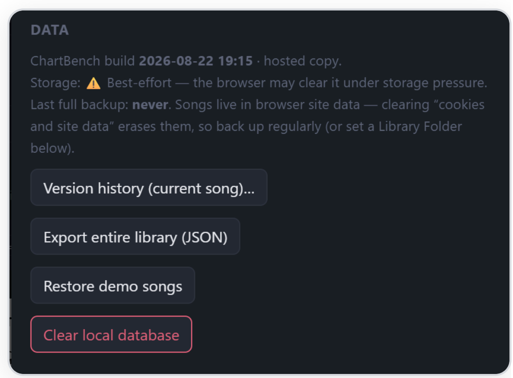


Fig. 36 — The Data section.

The **Library Folder** and **Feedback** sections are covered in chapters 18 and 20. At the bottom, **About ChartBench** names the author, the build you're running, the license, and links to this guide.

18 Your data: the Library Folder

ChartBench keeps songs in your browser's built-in database (IndexedDB), on your device. That's private — nothing leaves your machine, there's no account and no server — but it is *site data*: the browser's "clear cookies and site data" control wipes it, and each copy of the app (website, local file, second browser) has a separate library. The answer to both is the **Library Folder**.

Settings → Library Folder

Click **Choose folder...** and pick any folder on your computer. From that moment your library *lives there* as one `.json` file per song, named after the song — `Hotel California.json` — with saved set lists in a `Set Lists` subfolder, kept in step automatically:

- **Save** writes the song's file (rename a song and the file renames).
- **Delete** removes the file. **Import** adds one.
- Two *different* songs with the same title get told apart by artist — `Amazing Grace (Chris Tomlin).json` — or, failing that, a number. The file name is only a label: what ties a file to its song is an identity stored inside the file, so renaming a file by hand is harmless, and files from an earlier ChartBench that ended in a code (`Title--2a1c5e85.json`) are renamed to the plain form on the next sync.
- Every **launch** reconciles both ways: a newer file wins over the browser copy, a newer browser copy is written out, new files appear in the sidebar. If files were deleted on another machine, ChartBench **asks** before removing them here — so a cloud folder that hasn't finished downloading can never silently empty your library.

Sync now runs the reconcile on demand; **Forget** stops mirroring (the files stay where they are).

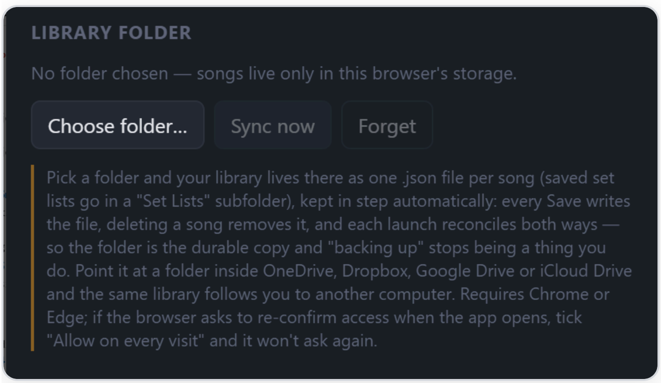


Fig. 37 — The Library Folder section before a folder is chosen.

Reconnecting

Browsers won't let a page hold a folder open forever: Chrome may ask to re-confirm access when the app opens. When it does, this strip appears at the top of the sidebar — click **Reconnect folder** and it syncs. Tick **"Allow on every visit"** in Chrome's prompt and it stops asking.

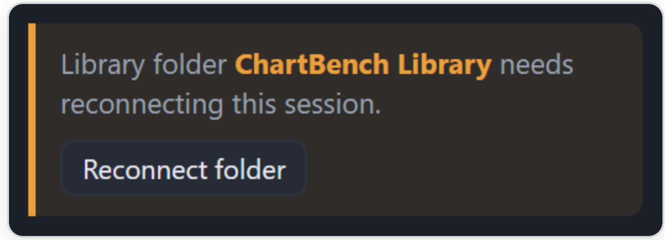


Fig. 38 — The reconnect strip.

> **Same library on two computers:** choose a folder inside OneDrive, Dropbox, Google Drive or iCloud Drive on the desktop, then point the other computer's ChartBench at the same folder. Both pull in everything and stay in step — the later edit wins if the same song is changed in two places before they sync. Set lists follow too. Attached PDFs in a set list stay with the browser they were attached in.

Requirements and fallbacks. The Library Folder needs a Chromium browser — Chrome, Edge, Brave — on Windows, Mac or Linux. Safari, Firefox, and every phone/tablet browser can't write to folders; on those, ChartBench works exactly as before: songs in browser storage, a quiet **backup reminder** above the song list after two weeks without a full backup, and **Export entire library** in Settings as the one-click backup. The library folder needs nothing of the sort — while it's connected, the reminder stays away, because the folder *is* the backup.

On startup ChartBench also asks the browser for **persistent storage**, which exempts the library from automatic eviction when disk space runs low (Settings → Data shows whether the browser agreed).

19 Keyboard shortcuts

Keys	Action
Ctrl + N	New song
Ctrl + S	Save
Ctrl + Z / Ctrl + Shift + Z	Undo / Redo (chart and Lyrics mode keep separate histories)
Ctrl + P	Print
← / →	Previous / next slide (Lyrics mode, Individual view, when the caret isn't in the editor)
Enter in the set-name box	Save set (Set List Builder)
Esc	Close the chord picker, note popup, or any dialog
Double-click	Chart: insert/edit a chord · Lyrics mode: line break
Right-click	Chart: insert a note · Lyrics mode: paragraph break (new slide) · Library: assign to libraries

20 Help, feedback & license

Debug & Feature Request

Found a bug, or want something added? **Settings → Feedback → Debug & Feature Request…** opens your device's email app with a message already started: a short template (bug or request, what happened, steps to reproduce) and a few facts that make a report traceable — which copy of ChartBench you're on, your browser, page size, library size. Everything else is yours to write; nothing is sent until you press Send. If something ever goes wrong inside the app, a small "Something went wrong" message appears, and the details of that error are attached to the next feedback email automatically — you don't have to describe it.

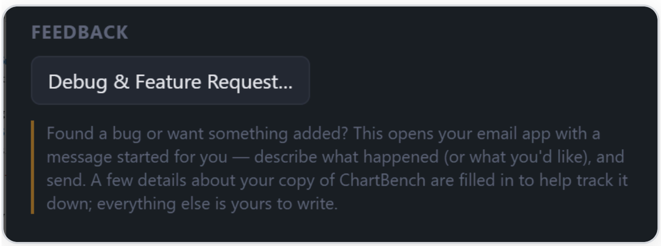


Fig. 39 — The Feedback section.

The **Guide** button in the top bar opens the latest edition of this guide. A PDF edition is available for printing or reading offline.

License

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Get the latest version — or your own offline copy — at **thechartbench.com**.